12. Implementing Security Features and Governance / Administration Practices in Zoho Creator

Aim

To study and configure security policies, role-based access control (RBAC), IP restrictions, audit trails and administrative governance practices for the **Student Admission Enquiry Management** application built using Zoho Creator, with the goal of protecting student records and controlling access to admission operations.

Overview

The Student Admission Enquiry Management application stores student identity and contact details, academic records, school lookup information, counselling status, supporting documents and parent consent. A secure implementation requires the following controls:

1. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

Concept: Define specific access permissions for administrators and authorized admissions users, controlling who can add, view, edit or delete form and report records.

Benefit: Limits exposure of applicants' personal and academic information and prevents unauthorized changes to verification or admission status.

2. Security Policies (Passwords, MFA and Sessions)

Concept: Apply strong authentication rules through the relevant Zoho account or organization administration controls, including password settings, multi-factor authentication (MFA) and session timeout policies.

Benefit: Reduces the risk of unauthorized access through stolen credentials or unattended sessions.

3. IP Restrictions

Concept: Restrict administrative or application access to trusted institutional network addresses when the relevant organizational plan and administrative settings support this.

Benefit: Adds a network-based restriction to sensitive admissions administration functions.

4. Audit Trails and Governance

Concept: Review available audit or activity records to monitor access, record modifications and workflow-related actions, alongside retention and permission reviews.

Benefit: Helps admissions administrators investigate data changes and maintain accountability.

Procedure

Step 1: Set Up Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

- Open the Student Admission Enquiry Management application in Zoho Creator and locate the available user, sharing and permission settings.
- Define suitable access levels, for example **Administrator** and **Admission Staff**. Use separate access levels only if multiple users actually require them.

- Assign Add, View, Edit and Delete privileges for Admission_Enquiry_Form, Schools Master Form and the relevant enquiry reports.
- Restrict editing of applicant-submitted identity and academic details; allow authorized updates to document verification, counselling and admission status.

Step 2: Configure Authentication and Security Policies

- Open the relevant Zoho organization administration or directory security settings, where available to the account.
- Review password policy options and enable appropriate multi-factor authentication requirements.
- Set reasonable idle-session and session-lifetime controls where supported, then verify the expected sign-in behavior.

Step 3: Configure Trusted IP Restrictions

- Identify any approved campus or administrative network IP addresses.
- In supported organization security settings, add these addresses to the appropriate IP restriction policy and assign that policy only to the intended users.
- Test permitted and denied access with an authorized test account before enforcing the rule broadly, to avoid locking out administrators.

Step 4: Review Audit Trails and Administration Controls

- Open available audit or activity logs and inspect changes to Admission_Enquiry_Form records and relevant workflow actions.
- Review whether modifications to verification, counselling and admission status are attributable to the appropriate user.
- Check access to uploaded student photos, marksheets and parent signatures, and periodically review active user permissions.

Application-Specific Security Considerations

- **Student data privacy:** Restrict visibility of contact details, date of birth, residential addresses and uploaded documents to authorized users.
- **Workflow administration:** Limit who can modify Notify Applicant, DOB_Validation, Scholarship_Percent_Validation and other enabled automations.
- **Payment data:** If payment collection is activated in the future, use a supported configured gateway and avoid storing sensitive payment credentials in custom form fields.

Verification Status

The material supplied for this experiment describes security and governance configuration procedures. **No screenshots of role permission settings, MFA enforcement, IP policy results or audit-log checks were provided**, so this record documents the intended implementation and checks, not verified completion of those controls.

Result

The security and governance requirements for the **Student Admission Enquiry Management** application were identified and documented. The experiment outlines how RBAC, authentication policies, IP restrictions, audit trails and session controls can safeguard admission records. Actual activation and effectiveness of these controls require verification in the applicable Zoho Creator and organization administration settings.